

MOVIE

Outside the wire

★★★★☆ | Picture this, the year is 2036, a violent civil war has erupted in Eastern Europe and US troops have been stationed there as peace-keepers. Are you big on sci-fi? This movie has oodles of it. Do you want robots? You've got it. Futuristic tech? Check. Action? Definitely. Mikael Håfström has certainly directed a movie that will keep you glued to the seat until the end.

Let us lay out the plot of the film for you. Lieutenant Thomas Harp (played by Damson Idris) is a drone pilot. He is one of the best in the business, and he is assigned to the war zone with Captain Leo (played by Anthony Mackie of Avengers fame) who is an Android Officer, Bio-tech



generation 4 to be precise. Their mission is to stop a nuclear attack from a crazy terrorist before time runs out.

While the direction, cinematography and scenes coupled with the sound effects make for a good visual and auditory experience, the biggest let

down is the movie's script. We found the movie's script to be ridiculously predictable, from start to finish. The ONLY thing that kept us going was everything else, really. It felt like some teenagers were given lots of money and told to write a generic action movie script with a futuristic theme slapped on top of it. The script is too straightforward, and has no twists and turns that usually come hand-in-hand with action films. The scriptwriting was a fail since they failed to simulate a real war situation and the whole movie is actually based on war. So, it's a real shame.

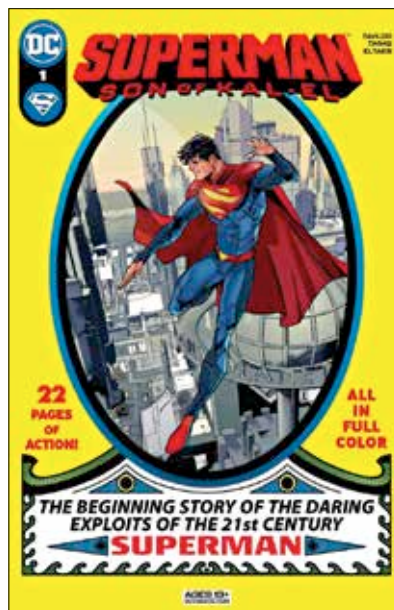
If we had to rate the movie based on action scenes and fantasy and fiction, it scores a good amount of points but considering everything else, it's pretty hard to recommend. If you are interesting in watching a film with good visuals and cinematography, go for it. Or if you simply want to kill some time, then by all means give it a watch. But other than that, the film gets a thumbs down from us.

COMIC

Superman: Son of Kal-El

★★★★☆ | This one starts off a bit like an old Bollywood movie, with a flashback scene going back to an alien invasion, or rather an attempted alien invasion that for once the Justice League is not worried about. Lois Lane and Superman welcome their son Jon to the world, with Wonder Woman and Batman watching on.

Cut to the present and we see Jon in action as the new Superman, unearthing an anxious metahuman who has lost control of their power at the heart of a forest fire. Superman tackles the problem intelligently and with compassion, without using excessive force or violence, and has to deal with other people in power who are not as kind to the metahumans. The



encounter makes him go seek help from his friend Damian Wayne, the son of Batman and Talia al Ghul.

The scenes and sequences are brilliant, the artwork is top notch, the action flows through the panels, but

there is something else at the heart of the comics that really makes it stand out. Superman was all about the heroic quest for truth and justice, and the next generation of Superman is all about this quest, tackling the incorporeal problems that are in store for mankind in the future, yet at the same time things that are more real than alien invasions or bitter deities. Jon and Damian are tackling the issues of climate change, social inequalities, protecting the freedom of press, and tackling an increasingly intolerant and polarised world. These are not exactly the kind of problems that you can solve by punching someone in the face. In just one issue, the stage is set, we know the issues that the next generation will fight, and this is a promise to use the guiding principles of truth and justice to seek out solutions. The new series is brilliant and timely reading, showing how the next generation of superheroes will tackle the problems of tomorrow, and is a fascinating start to what looks like another epic joyride.